

Hon. Michelle Schauer
Westchester Family Court
Yonkers, New York

To whom it may concern:

This was my fourth time up for a visit with Evie in the past month. The drive, as you may know, about six and half hours each way. It is very hard to do every week. The first week, I was made to turn around by Stephen Walsh and head home without seeing Evie. He was terribly rude and does not act like a Grandparent should. He acts like Evie belongs to him.

Do you know that Tara lied to the Court about moving out and having a home for Evie? Do you know that her address is "confidential" because Maura and Steve Walsh view themselves as having custody of her. I am very worried about Tara and Evie. I think that Tara needs to be able to leave Westchester if she wants to, she is welcome to come stay with me in Pennsylvania for a week.

Do you know Tara's parents threatened to sue Tara if she moved out and Tara writes and posts pictures about being kept in the attic? You should know these things. They matter. After Tara went to New York, she started sending me text messages about her treatment at her parents' home. She said she wasn't fed and that she hated it. She wanted to leave desperately, but "things get bad" when she says she wants to leave. Tara lived in San Francisco with me and my son for many weeks before Evie was born and after. Tara was estranged from her family all those years. None of this makes sense. Every time, I have called the Walshes to find out what is going on, they just hang up on me. Something is not right at that house.

Generally the visit today went very well. We went to a park and the beach. We found a crab and had a ton of fun. When Tara called early and asked if Evie wanted to be picked up, Evie said "**No.**" Evie wasn't being mean to her Mother, she just isn't shy about saying what she wants and she and I have a lot of fun. Steve's brother Jonathan has two children a little older than Evie that I helped raise, and I was a nurse for many years, so other than the drive and some antics from the Walsh family, everything goes very smoothly.

There were some very concerning things, however. Evie asks about and wants to see her Dad. Tara tells Evie, and says in front of her, both that her Dad is here at the hotel and that Dad can't be with her because he's not allowed. Evie is very confused about this. Evie does not know why Mommy says Dad is bad. She asks questions about it like "Is Daddy sick." Or, "Daddy are you sick." Or, "Doesn't Daddy miss/like me?" At the same time, Tara makes Evie think Dad is at the actual hotel! Evie thinks her Dad rejecting her because he is nearby and not seeing here. It's a terribly cruel thing to do.

Tara is extremely paranoid about Steve. She would not provide Evie a a car seat because she "thinks Steve will bug it." I had to purchase a car seat for the driver, because Tara would not provide. Tara was late today and Evie was unfed, very tired and cranky. She was crying when she arrived and Tara told me it was because Evie did not want to see me. But Evie stopped as soon she knew we were going to get her something to eat. Evie's shoes were too small and inappropriate. She does not seem to be getting any exercise or spending anytime outside when with Maura Walsh and has low agility. I don't think she is

getting very much exercise at all despite all this talk of swimming lessons etc. Evie seems to just be kept near Maura Walsh out of anxiety that someone will take her.

Please issue a summons to Steve and Maura Walsh for the next Court date. You need to meet Maura and Steve Walsh, and you will know right away something is very wrong. Please look up the Walsh Family hearing when Tara tried to get emancipation from her parents. Tara lived with me and my son for many many weeks while they were dating and after Evie was born. Over more than two years, I never heard from them. Tara said she was estranged and that they had abused her and sent her to an awful place when she was young. After Tara was caught putting drugs in my son's wine and she had the episode where she dropped Evie, the Walsh family still never called me. I think we've exchanged just a few phone calls in six years. Tara wanted nothing to do with them and now she is keeping the fact that she lives with them secret.

Other things the Court should know about the visit are that Evie was exhausted by lunch, much more so than I would expect so she took a very long nap in the afternoon. Tara called early and said she had a dentist appointment and needed to pick Evie up at about 4 instead of 5:30. It was then that Tara asked out loud to Evie if she wanted Mommy to pick her up and Evie said no. Evie made it clear that she didn't want to go with Mommy. Mommy came anyway and picked up Evie early. Couldn't Tara have scheduled her Dentist for a different day or time? Did she not know about the appointment? Why tell me only then? I always have to be flexible and give more notice, but she couldn't pick up Evie AFTER the dentist appointment? Wouldn't that have been better?

When Tara arrived, she stated that Evie started swimming lessons every day next week and had ballet on Thursdays. She asked if I would take weekends instead. It was shocking to me that a Mom who was gone all week wanted to give Evie away on the weekends. Tara is not spending very much time with Evie, I don't think. How is it that you all aren't seeing this? This is not great for Evie and I worry that Tara does not realize what her parents are doing. They have her so worried that my Son is going to take Evie, but very much act to me like they intend to have custody of Evie when this is all over.

Evie arrived with an injury on her face and Tara said Evie had fallen. Things happen to kids I know. But, Evie seems to have a lot of injuries, sickness, allergies. Too many. Evie is not potty trained, and I don't think anyone is really helping her with that. We made a lot of progress in one day, so I don't know why this is the case. Tara does not provide diapers when she drops off Evie. That isn't really like Tara, in my opinion and I worry that she is being pressured to make my visits difficult because they are so stressful for Tara's parents.

This is a very long way to drive for a day that Tara cuts short and the start and brings Evie without proper sleep, diapers, or a car seat. Then picks her up early. She is not taking good care of Evie and is very paranoid about Steve. Very very very very paranoid. The reason Tara says she does not want Dad to see Evie is because she is deathly afraid that Steve will take her. There is no other reason. Steve would not do this, but I think that child services probably should.

Evie is fine with strangers, despite what you hear. She knows her Dad, asks for her Dad and should not be being told that he is here and can't or doesn't want to see her. That is terrible. I am not sure why Evie

can meet strangers at swim practice, strangers at ballet, and a strange driver, and strangers at a hotel, but can't FaceTime with Dad unless some person named Jen Culley is there. Who on God's green earth is Jen Culley? And why is she more important than Evie getting to see her Dad? Is Jen Culley willing to be with Evie in person, like me. Is Jen Culley willing to take care of Evie without cost? I don't understand why Tara's attorney and Jennifer Jackman would demand her, when I am a nurse, sent two boys to Stanford, and just finished two years helping raise two other Grandchildren. Tara's attorney, Jennifer Jackman, Tara's Parents all make such fuss over who can be at these things, but they never ever call me and ask a single question about the visits.

Lastly, I was told that everyone was very upset about the blog and thinks the last visits were video'd and not like what was said. That's malarkey. No one recorded anything and Evie did spend all day with her Dad. *She likes him. She likes having a Dad. She doesn't understand why she doesn't have one.* She asks about him and it clear that she has been told he is sick and can't be with her because the Court said so. Why is the Court telling Evie she can't see her Dad? What possible reason do you have? Can anyone say one reason? Is it really just so there isn't a blog post or something? How can Jen Culley stop any of that stuff? She can't. But, the Court said don't record anything, so we didn't. I should not be being treated so differently from the Walshes.

They abused their kids and Tara sued them for emancipation. They have been warned many times by police about the things they do. Tara called CPS on them many many times. I just have a lovely time with my granddaughter, but I can't be trusted to manage a FaceTime? That is just terribly frustrating to me, and if you saw how upsetting it was to Evie to keep having her Dad taken from her, again and again, you wouldn't even consider it. You should have let me record the visits. I am not going to post anything and then you could see how wonderful Evie and her Dad are together. There are videos and pictures and reports from the nannies and supervisors for past visits too, I was at. You should look at those. Steve is a very good Dad.

This whole things just disgusts me and you all should just be ashamed of yourselves. Tara did a terrible thing and always makes things as hard as can be on me. Everything is chaos. Nothing is her fault. She takes responsibility for nothing. It's something new each time. And it's always tiptoeing around Maura and Steve at the bottom of it.

From the stories, I don't want to make them angry either. But, why can't I pick up Evie up from Maura Walsh? No one can say. Don't ask about that. No. No. No. Do you not think it's odd that Evie's grandparents are so central to her life, actually claim custody in the San Francisco depositions, but are scared to death of me for some reason. Isn't that a little bit suspicious? Do you think maybe the reason they are so nutty about this because they know what really happened. Have you looked at their depositions from the San Francisco battery case? That family is bonkers. I am worried for Evie and Tara. Tara doesn't even know that half what her parents are doing and it breaks my heart. Evie is so important to them that can't answer the phone? They can't send an email? They can't be involved? But they they are Evie's primary care givers.

How do you let someone like that keep Evie? Do you not know what that family does to their children? The court received hundreds of pages of abuse documentation from the Walsh family's OWN CHILDREN and their children's lawyers over the years. Did anyone read that?

And what they are doing to this poor little girl playing games like this. Not one person, not one has corroborated anything Tara said. Even her own family. They ignore the fact that Tara looked up famous women poisoners. They ignore the fact that she looked up a LETHAL dose of the drug. They ignore the fact that she admitted to drugging my son. They were caught drugging their youngest they daughter too. What a family! Everybody thinks it's ok to drug someone. That's what "helping" means.

And they make some big deal out of the fact he thought he was being drugged in New York and had a driver who was a former NYPD cop. He WAS being drugged! You might hire a security person too if that was happening to you, but for heaven's sake that was three and half years ago and he hasn't had any security people since he found out it was Tara. Is that really the best you have? You think Evie should not have a Dad because he thought he was being drugged when he was REALLY being drugged?

I don't know who you people are, but you all share the blame for this. A blog post? FaceTime? Who are you? You went to law school for this? You must know the harm you are causing this girl. I have never in all my days imagined anything so backward. You can't possibly imagine that you are helping Tara or Evie. They are caught in the middle. Tara was doing so much better in San Francisco. If Tara goes to jail and loses Evie, it will be because you spent so long ignoring what was really going on. Tara and her sister both write about all of this stuff on their website things. Lots of pictures with Evie too, but a video of Evie's first steps can't be shared. Please read Tara and her sister's website. Very interesting.

How anyone could have read that wonderful writeup about the visit, that was spot on by the way, and experience anything but your heart melting. I don't know, some boy or girl must have hurt you very badly along on the way and I am sorry. Did anyone of you ask Steve about the visit? You didn't ask me? Now that you know that post is true, you should reread it. Evie wants to have a Dad.

The only two things not included in that post that you should know about have to do with Evie wanting to play guns at the start of the visit when she arrived. Why does a 3.5 year old want to play guns? We moved her to something else very quickly, but who is teaching her that? Do you even know who lives at the Walsh compound? And at the end of that visit, Tara and her parents arranged for me to be "served" with a fake something from a fake police officer so I would know what it feels like I presume. Tara waited while it happened and positively gloated. Thankfully Evie was asleep.

Tara sends pictures to Steve with guns in her hand, I have seen them. She sent one when she was pregnant saying she had protect the baby. You should ask to see those. Her family has many police officers in it and Tara's brother is very goofy and loves that kind of stuff. Tara might not own a gun herself, but she sure does take a lot of pictures with one and no one seems to be asking the Walsh family any questions about this. Somebody at that home has a gun, or Tara wouldn't be able to take pictures. A 3.5 year old should not want to play guns.

It is fine though, and I distracted Evie and she has no idea what a gun really is, but my goodness. Zooms? FaceTimes? And you have people whose job it is to watch FaceTimes with parents. Why don't you go do something useful and help this poor girl to have a father rather than stomping your feet over such silliness.

When Tara had her breakdown in San Francisco, her parents were begged to come and help her. But they could not be bothered because six hour flights are "not something a person just does" or some

such nonsense. People like the Walsh's wouldn't fly six hours for their daughter and granddaughter, and now they MUST keep Evie... they are so concerned about a day over three years ago BEFORE Tara moved to San Francisco. So....concerned about a day they have never talked to anyone about. You know Maura Walsh diagnosed everybody in that house with the same thing, right? Well she is not a doctor, and when a good one in San Francisco finally saw Tara he thought her BPD was probably because of all the medication her mother gave her for so long.

They couldn't fly 6 hours when Tara had her breakdown and sent Evie to the Emergency room, but I have to drive 13 hours every week for a shortened visit?

Steve and Maura Walsh deliberately make this as horrible as they can for Evie and me so my son goes away. They hurt me and Evie every visit, sometimes a little and sometimes a lot. They just want to be able to keep his daughter and be done with it. They don't want Steve to have a relationship with her, they don't want me to have one, and at the end of the day I don't think want Tara to have one either, but she just doesn't know what to do.

It has been three years of this stuff. How much time does Tara get to prove a case she's said now again and again was a lie? Five years? 10 years? Someone should not be able to say something false to kidnap a child and get away with it.

Sincerely,


Linda A. Russell

PS - This is my letter. I talked and got help typing what I said, so I am sorry it's so long and maybe I said too much, but I am upset about all of this and worried. I love my granddaughter and Tara could be doing so much better too. My son emailed me what I said and I made some changes and signed it. If you have any questions, please call me.